

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with a year of litigation support experience at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner across international arbitration and real estate disputes, and ongoing client-facing legal advisory work at Citizens Advice. Skilled in evidence review, electronic bundling, drafting procedural documents, managing case files, tracking deadlines and handling court logistics. Experienced working under deadline pressure on complex, multi-document matters. Seeking temporary litigation paralegal placements in London to build further practical experience ahead of SQE qualification.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, evidence analysis and legal research
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy): 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **July 2026 – Present**

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from instruction to submission: takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies, identifies evidential gaps and relevant legal issues
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines across welfare, housing, employment, debt and family matters
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria and researches complex legal points to support clients with live proceedings and applications
- Translates procedural requirements and legal rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial on a complex investment arbitration
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended substantive sections of the Claimant's memorial
- Became the sole junior supporting the team before a major submission deadline: coordinated outstanding documents, tracked actions and helped ensure on-time delivery
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and other court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed court filings, hearing arrangements and matter opening and closure processes; tracked deadlines and prepared cost comparisons
- Maintained matter records via iManage; managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines
- Prepared client notes and maintained up-to-date matter records throughout

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; met client and supervisor deadlines throughout

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: iManage; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; legal research databases; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; case management and time-recording systems; document review platforms

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, procedural document drafting, case-file organisation, deadline tracking, court filing and matter administration